

# WORLD CUP 2026



THE ULTIMATE SOUVENIR GUIDEBOOK

# WORLD CUP HISTORY & LEGENDS

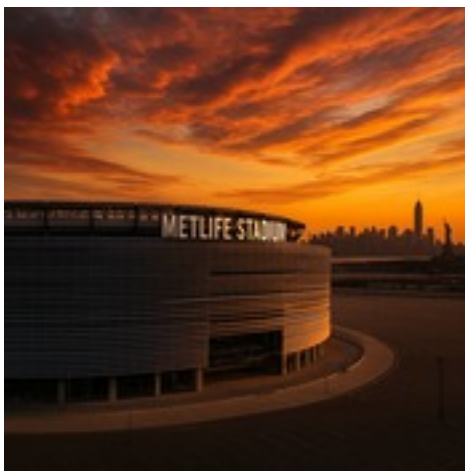
1930  
URUGUAY

1954  
SWITZERLAND

1970  
BRAZIL

1998  
FRANCE





## #1 MetLife Stadium \* The Silver Giant

New York / NJ

### CITY SPOTLIGHT

**Statue of Liberty** Standing tall in the harbor, this iconic lady has welcomed visitors to the New York area for over 100 years!

**Linguistically Diverse NYC** is the most diverse city on Earth, with over 800 different languages spoken by its amazing residents!

**Broadway Stars** The famous theater district hosts 41 professional theaters and draws 12 million excited fans every single year!

**Pizza Capital** With more than 1,600 pizzerias, you are never more than a few blocks away from a world-famous New York slice!

### STADIUM FACTS

**Massive Capacity** With 82,500 seats, this stadium is big enough to hold a whole city of cheering soccer fans!

**Silver Louvers** The stadium's unique silver exterior can glow in different colors to match the teams playing on the field!

**Steel Giant** It took 40,000 tons of steel to build this stadium, which is the same weight as 8,000 massive African elephants!

**The Big Stage** This legendary venue has been chosen to host the 2026 World Cup Final, where the new world champion will be crowned!

### WOW MOMENTS

**Meadowlands Magic** The stadium is part of a giant 750-acre sports and entertainment complex that was once just a swampy marsh!

**Yellow Cabs** There are over 13,000 iconic yellow taxis zipping through the city streets, making them a true symbol of New York!

**Times Square** About 330,000 people walk through this neon-lit intersection every day, making it one of the busiest places on the planet!

**Glowing Nights** At night, the entire stadium glows brilliantly, creating a stunning view that can be seen from miles away!



## Player Profile

### Christian Pulisic | USA

Forward | AC Milan

#### CAREER

**Captain America** Christian Pulisic is the leader of the US team and earned his nickname by being a hero on the soccer pitch!

**Speed Demon** Known for his explosive speed and amazing dribbling, Christian can zip past defenders before they even see him!

**Dortmund Debut** He started his professional career in Germany with Borussia Dortmund when he was just 16 years old!

**Young Record-Breaker** Christian holds the record for being the youngest player to ever captain the US Men's National Team!

#### ACHIEVEMENTS

**National Hero** He has played over 60 times for the USA and has scored 29 goals, including a huge one in the 2022 World Cup!

**Champions League** Christian was the first American man to ever play in and win a UEFA Champions League final!

**Player of the Year** He is so talented that he has been named the US Soccer Male Player of the Year three different times!

**Key Playmaker** Since his debut in 2016, he has been the most important player for the United States in every big tournament!

#### EXTRA

**Hershey Born** Christian was born and raised in Hershey, Pennsylvania, which is also famous for making delicious chocolate!

**Forward Focus** Whether he is playing for AC Milan in Italy or the USA, Christian always plays as an attacking forward!

**Scoring Touch** He is famous for his 'clutch' goals, meaning he scores when his team needs him the most during big games!

**Soccer Family** Soccer is in his blood; both of his parents played college soccer and his father even played professionally!



## #2 Lincoln Financial Field \* The Linc

Philadelphia, PA

### CITY SPOTLIGHT

**Brotherly Love** Philadelphia is known as the 'City of Brotherly Love' and was the first capital of the United States!

**The Liberty Bell** This famous bell with its giant crack is a symbol of American freedom and lives right in the heart of Philly!

**Soft Pretzel City Philly** is world-famous for its delicious soft pretzels and refreshing 'Water Ice' treats that kids love!

**Mural Masterpiece** Philadelphia has more outdoor murals than any other city in the world, turning the streets into a giant art gallery!

### STADIUM FACTS

**Solar Power** The Linc is covered in 11,000 solar panels, which generate enough clean energy to power 1,000 homes!

**Wind Turbines** To be even greener, the stadium has 14 wind turbines that spin in the breeze to create electricity!

**Eagle Wings** The stadium's architecture features unique 'wing' shapes on the roof to match the Eagles team that plays there!

**Historic Turf** Beyond soccer, this field has hosted the famous Army-Navy college football game many times since 1890!

### WOW MOMENTS

**Rocky Steps** You can run up the 72 stone steps at the Art Museum just like Rocky Balboa did in his famous movies!

**Cheesesteak Challenge** Visitors love to try the city's famous cheesesteaks, usually choosing between 'Pat's' or 'Geno's' shops!

**Pope's Visit** In 2015, the stadium was so important that Pope Francis held a massive outdoor mass right on the field!

**Super Fans** Philly fans are known as some of the loudest and most passionate in the world, making the stadium shake with noise!



## Player Profile

### Vincius Jnior | Brazil

Forward | Real Madrid

#### CAREER

**Vini Jr. Vincius Jnior** is a superstar forward from Brazil who uses his incredible skills to dazzle fans around the world!

**Samba Dribbler** Growing up in Brazil, Vini learned to dribble with 'Samba' style, making him one of the hardest players to stop!

**Jersey Number 7** He wears the legendary number 7 for Real Madrid, the same number worn by many of the greatest players ever!

**Futsal Beginnings** Vini started playing futsal, a fast-paced indoor version of soccer, which helped him develop his lightning-fast footwork!

#### ACHIEVEMENTS

**Champions League Hero** He scored the winning goal in the 2022 Champions League final, making him a legend for Real Madrid!

**Double Final Scorer** He is so talented that he has actually scored in two different Champions League final matches!

**Brazil Pride** Vini has represented Brazil over 30 times and even helped them win the Copa Amrica trophy in 2019!

**Big Transfer** Real Madrid was so impressed by him that they signed him when he was only 18 years old for a huge fee!

#### EXTRA

**So Gonalo** Vini was born in So Gonalo, a city near Rio de Janeiro, where he first started dreaming of becoming a soccer star!

**Helping Hands** He runs his own charity called the Vini Jr. Institute to help use technology to improve education for kids in Brazil!

**Real Madrid Star** He plays for Real Madrid in Spain, one of the most famous and successful soccer clubs in the entire world!

**Joyful Play** Vini is famous for playing with a big smile on his face and celebrating his goals with amazing dance moves!



## #3 FedExField \* The FedEx Giant

Landover, MD (DC)

### CITY SPOTLIGHT

**Capitol Capital** Washington D.C. is the center of the US government and is home to the White House and the beautiful Capitol building!

**Cherry Blossoms** Every spring, the city turns pink when 3,000 cherry trees, a gift from Japan, bloom all at once!

**No Skyscrapers** D.C. has no tall skyscrapers because no building is allowed to be much taller than the street is wide!

**Library of Congress** This amazing building is the largest library in the entire world, with millions of books on its shelves!

### STADIUM FACTS

**Huge Footprint** FedExField is one of the largest stadiums in the NFL, with enough room for 82,000 fans to watch the action!

**Parking King** The stadium has over 30,000 parking spaces, making it one of the biggest parking lots in all of sports!

**Concert Central** When the game is over, the stadium hosts giant concerts for stars like Beyonc and the Rolling Stones!

**Global Concourse** Fans from all over the world gather here to fly their flags and celebrate their favorite teams!

### WOW MOMENTS

**National Mall** This 2-mile long park is filled with history, from the Lincoln Memorial to the towering Washington Monument!

**Free Museums** All 19 Smithsonian museums in the city are completely free to visit, so you can see dinosaurs and space shuttles for free!

**Giant Park** Rock Creek Park is a massive forest inside the city that is actually twice as large as New York's Central Park!

**Winter Fun** In the winter, the city's Sculpture Garden turns into a giant outdoor ice rink where families go skating!



## Player Profile

### Harry Kane | England

Striker | Bayern Munich

#### CAREER

**England Captain** Harry Kane is the leader of the England national team and one of the best strikers to ever play the game!

**Penalty King** Harry is famous for his incredible accuracy from the penalty spot, scoring over 90% of the penalties he takes!

**Premier League Legend** Before moving to Germany, Harry scored against every single Premier League team he ever faced!

**Striker Power** Whether playing for Bayern Munich or England, Harry is always the 'Number 9' who leads the attack!

#### ACHIEVEMENTS

**All-Time Scorer** Harry Kane holds the amazing record for scoring the most goals in the history of the England national team!

**Golden Boot** He won the World Cup Golden Boot in 2018 for being the top scorer of the whole tournament with 6 goals!

**Triple Winner** He has won the Premier League Golden Boot award three different times for being the league's best scorer!

**Royal Honor** Because he is such a great representative for his country, the Queen awarded him an MBE medal!

#### EXTRA

**London Born** Harry was born in London, England, and grew up very close to the stadium where his first pro team played!

**Labrador Love** Harry has two beautiful Labrador dogs named Brady and Wilson, who are named after famous NFL quarterbacks!

**Late Bloomer** When he was very young, one team told him he wasn't good enough, but he worked hard and proved them all wrong!

**Teamwork** First Even though he scores many goals, Harry is famous for helping his teammates and being a great friend on the field!



## #4 Hard Rock Stadium \* Hard Rock Hero

Miami Gardens, FL

### CITY SPOTLIGHT

**Sunshine City** Miami is known for its beautiful beaches and gets about 248 days of bright sunshine every single year!

**Art Deco Style** The South Beach area is famous for its 'Art Deco' buildings, which are painted in bright, beautiful neon colors!

**Nature's Mix** Miami is the only place in the world where both alligators and crocodiles live together in the wild!

**Cruise Capital** The Port of Miami is the busiest cruise ship port in the world, with giant ships leaving for the islands every day!

### STADIUM FACTS

**Shade for All** The stadium has a massive 'open-air' canopy that covers 90% of the seats to keep fans dry and out of the sun!

**F1 Race Track** Once a year, the area around the stadium is turned into a high-speed Formula 1 race track for the Miami Grand Prix!

**Ship Mast Spires** The four huge white spires at the corners of the stadium are designed to look like the masts of a giant ship!

**Tropical Vibe** With its open corners and ocean breezes, watching a game here feels like being at a giant tropical party!

### WOW MOMENTS

**Latin Music** Miami is the capital of Latin music, where you can hear the sounds of salsa, reggaeton, and bachata everywhere you go!

**Wynwood Walls** The city is home to the world's largest collection of street art, where giant murals cover every building!

**Skyline Views** Miami has the third tallest skyline in the United States, filled with shimmering glass towers along the ocean!

**Park Paradise** Miami is the only US city bordered by two different National Parks: the Everglades and Biscayne National Park!



## Player Profile

### Lionel Messi | Argentina

Forward | Inter Miami CF

#### CAREER

**The GOAT** Many fans believe Lionel Messi is the 'Greatest of All Time' because of his incredible magic with the soccer ball!

**Argentina's Star** Messi has played a record 180 matches for Argentina and has scored over 100 goals for his home country!

**Inter Miami** After playing in Europe for many years, Messi moved to Florida to play for Inter Miami CF in the United States!

**Record Breaker** In the year 2012, Messi scored an unbelievable 91 goals, which is the world record for the most goals in one year!

#### ACHIEVEMENTS

**World Cup Winner** In 2022, Messi finally achieved his biggest dream by leading Argentina to victory in the World Cup!

**Ballon d'Or** He has been named the best player in the world 8 times, winning the Ballon d'Or trophy more than anyone else!

**Trophy King** Messi has won 44 team trophies in his career, which is the most by any soccer player in the history of the sport!

**Goal Machine** He has scored over 800 goals in his career, including some of the most beautiful solo runs ever seen!

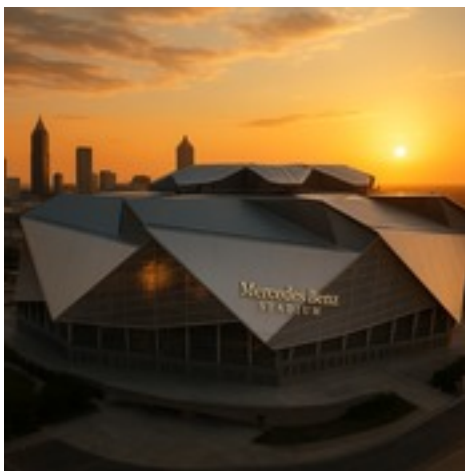
#### EXTRA

**Rosario Born** Messi was born in Rosario, Argentina, and started playing for a local club when he was only five years old!

**Growth Miracle** When he was a kid, he was very small and needed special medicine to help him grow tall enough to play pro soccer!

**Favorite Food** His favorite meal is 'Milanesa a la Napolitana,' which is a special Argentine steak covered in cheese and sauce!

**Napkin Contract** He was so good as a child that his first contract with FC Barcelona was written on a paper napkin at a restaurant!



## #5 Mercedes-Benz Stadium \* The Benz

Atlanta, GA

### CITY SPOTLIGHT

**Busy Skies** Atlanta's airport is the busiest in the entire world, with thousands of planes taking off and landing every single day!

**Forest City** Atlanta is known as the 'City in a Forest' because it has more trees covering it than almost any other major city!

**Coke's Home** The world-famous Coca-Cola drink was invented right here in Atlanta way back in the year 1886!

**The Peach State** Georgia is famous for its peaches, but surprisingly, its biggest and most valuable crop is actually peanuts!

### STADIUM FACTS

**Petal Roof** The stadium's roof is made of 8 giant 'petals' that open and close just like a blooming flower in only 8 minutes!

**Halo Board** Inside, there is a giant 360-degree video screen called the 'Halo Board' that is the largest screen in all of sports!

**Super Green** This stadium is 'LEED Platinum' certified, which means it is one of the most environmentally friendly buildings ever made!

**Fan-Friendly** The stadium is famous for its low food prices, where fans can get hot dogs and popcorn for just a few dollars!

### WOW MOMENTS

**Giant Aquarium** Atlanta is home to the Georgia Aquarium, which is the largest in the US and holds 6 million gallons of water!

**Sky High** You can ride 'SkyView Atlanta,' a massive 20-story tall Ferris wheel that gives you a view of the whole city!

**Zoo Atlanta** The city's zoo is one of the only places in the United States where you can see giant pandas playing!

**Tech Wonder** The stadium's massive video board is so big that a jumbo jet could actually fit inside the screen!



## Player Profile

### Kylian Mbappé | France

Forward | Real Madrid

#### CAREER

**French Phenom** Kylian Mbappé is a lightning-fast superstar from France who is considered the best young player in the world!

**Real Madrid Bound** After scoring hundreds of goals in France for PSG, Kylian moved to Spain to play for the famous Real Madrid!

**Record Speed** Kylian is one of the fastest players ever recorded, reaching speeds of 38 km/h almost as fast as a car!

**Goal Leader** He has already won 6 league titles in France and has been the top scorer of the league for many years in a row!

#### ACHIEVEMENTS

**World Cup Winner** Kylian became a legend at just 19 years old when he helped France win the 2018 World Cup!

**Hat-Trick Hero** In the 2022 World Cup final, he scored three goals (a hat-trick), something that hadn't been done in 50 years!

**Golden Boot** He won the Golden Boot award at the 2022 World Cup for being the tournament's top scorer with 8 goals!

**France's Future** Kylian is the captain of the French national team and is on his way to breaking all of their scoring records!

#### EXTRA

**Bondy Born** Kylian was born in Bondy, a small town near Paris, where his father was his very first soccer coach!

**Ninja Turtle** His teammates give him the funny nickname 'Donatello' because they think he looks like one of the Teenage Mutant Ninja Turtles!

**Giving Back** After winning the World Cup in 2018, he donated all of his prize money to a charity that helps sick and disabled children!

**Childhood Dreams** As a kid, his bedroom walls were completely covered in posters of his hero, Cristiano Ronaldo!



## #6 NRG Stadium \* NRG Neo

Houston, TX

### CITY SPOTLIGHT

**Space City** Houston is home to NASA's Mission Control, which is why it is famously known around the world as 'Space City!'

**Foodie Heaven** Houston has one of the most diverse food scenes in America, with over 70 different types of global cuisines to try!

**Music Hub** The city is a major center for live music and is the birthplace of many famous singers and superstar performers!

**Energy Capital** Houston is known as the 'Energy Capital of the World' because so many of the world's oil and gas companies are based there!

### STADIUM FACTS

**First of its Kind** NRG Stadium was the very first NFL stadium in the United States to be built with a retractable roof!

**Rodeo Ready** Every year, the stadium is filled with dirt and animals for the Houston Livestock Show and Rodeo, the largest in the world!

**Soccer History** This field has hosted many huge games, including matches for the Copa America and several Super Bowls!

**Massive Space** The stadium can hold over 72,000 fans, and the floor space is large enough to host almost any event imaginable!

### WOW MOMENTS

**Real Rockets** At Space Center Houston nearby, you can walk inside a real space shuttle and see giant Saturn V rockets!

**Multi-Sport** The stadium is so well-designed that it can switch from a soccer field to a rodeo arena in just a few days!

**Tunnel System** 20 feet below the city streets is a 7-mile long tunnel system filled with shops and restaurants for people to enjoy!

**Medical Center** Houston is home to the world's largest medical complex, where doctors help thousands of people every day!



## Player Profile

### Victor Osimhen | Nigeria

Striker | Galatasaray

#### CAREER

**Nigerian Star** Victor Osimhen is a powerful striker from Nigeria who is famous for his incredible strength and scoring ability!

**Striker Power** Victor plays as a 'Center Forward,' meaning his main job is to use his speed to get behind defenders and score!

**Goal Machine** During the 2022-23 season in Italy, he scored 31 goals, proving he is one of the best finishers on the planet!

**Super Eagle** He is the star player for the Nigeria national team, which is nicknamed the 'Super Eagles' by their fans!

#### ACHIEVEMENTS

**African Player of the Year** In 2023, Victor was officially named the best soccer player in all of Africa!

**Napoli Legend** He led his team, Napoli, to their first Italian league title in 33 years, making him a hero in the city of Naples!

**Serie A Record** Victor holds the record for being the highest-scoring African player in the history of the Italian 'Serie A' league!

**Academy Start** He began his soccer journey at the 'Ultimate Strikers Academy' in Lagos, Nigeria, before moving to Europe!

#### EXTRA

**Lagos Born** Victor was born in Lagos, Nigeria, and as a kid, he helped his family by selling bottled water in the busy city streets!

**The Masked Man** Victor wears a special black protective mask during every game, which has become his famous trademark look!

**Fighting Spirit** He is known for never giving up on a ball and using his amazing 'leap' to win headers high in the air!

**Helping Others** Victor is very proud of his roots and often helps young soccer players in Nigeria reach their dreams of playing pro!



## #7 AT&T Stadium \* Titan Tex

Arlington, TX (Dallas)

### CITY SPOTLIGHT

**Cowboy Culture** Dallas is a city where you can see real cowboys, visit the State Fair of Texas, and eat world-class BBQ!

**BBQ Capital** Texas is famous for its slow-cooked BBQ, and Dallas is one of the best places to find delicious brisket and ribs!

**Six Flags** The very first 'Six Flags' theme park was opened right here in the Dallas area over 60 years ago!

**Tallest Wheel** Dallas is home to the 'Texas Star,' which was the tallest Ferris wheel in North America for many years!

### STADIUM FACTS

**Jerry World** This stadium is so big and expensive that people nickname it 'Jerry World' after the owner of the Dallas Cowboys!

**Video Giant** The stadium features a massive video board that is 160 feet wide that's actually longer than a Boeing 737 airplane!

**Glass Doors** The stadium has the world's largest retractable glass doors, which can open up to let in the fresh Texas air!

**Expandable Seats** While it usually holds 80,000 people, the stadium can expand to hold a massive crowd of 105,000 fans!

### WOW MOMENTS

**Frozen Drinks** Did you know the very first frozen margarita machine was invented in Dallas in the year 1971?

**TV Overload** There are over 3,000 high-definition TVs located throughout the stadium, so you never miss a second of the game!

**Power Hungry** On a game day, this stadium uses more electricity than an entire small town does in a whole day!

**Fair Fun** The stadium is located right near the site of the State Fair of Texas, where you can see the 55-foot tall 'Big Tex' statue!



## Player Profile

### Son Heung-min | South Korea

Forward | Tottenham

#### CAREER

**Asia's Icon** Son Heung-min is the most famous soccer player in Asia and the captain of both the South Korea team and Tottenham!

**Two-Footed Magic** Son is famous for being able to kick the ball perfectly with both his left and right feet, making him a defender's nightmare!

**Tottenham Star** He has played in England for Tottenham Hotspur for many years and has scored over 150 goals for the club!

**Forward Focus** Son uses his amazing speed and clever runs to play as a forward or a winger on the side of the field!

#### ACHIEVEMENTS

**Golden Boot** Son made history in 2022 by becoming the first Asian player ever to win the Premier League Golden Boot!

**Pusks Award** In 2019, he won the Pusks Award for the 'Best Goal of the Year' after a 70-meter solo run where he beat the whole team!

**Korea's Captain** He has played over 120 times for South Korea and has led them in three different World Cup tournaments!

**Military Service** In 2020, Son showed his dedication by completing his mandatory military training in South Korea during his break!

#### EXTRA

**Chuncheon Born** Son was born in Chuncheon, South Korea, and was coached by his father, who was also a professional soccer player!

**Camera Celebration** Every time he scores, Son makes a 'camera' shape with his hands to show he is 'capturing' the happy memory!

**Piano Player** When he is not playing soccer, Son loves to relax by playing the piano or playing fun video games with his friends!

**Hard Worker** His father once made him practice keepy-uppies for four hours straight without dropping the ball to help him get better!



## #8 SoFi Stadium \* The Infinity Giant

Inglewood, CA (LA)

### CITY SPOTLIGHT

**Hollywood Magic** Los Angeles is the movie capital of the world, where you can find the Walk of Fame and the famous Hollywood Sign!

**Beach Life LA** has some of the most famous beaches in the world, like Venice Beach and Santa Monica, where people surf all year!

**Landmark Sign** The giant 'HOLLYWOOD' sign on the hill originally said 'HOLLYWOODLAND' when it was first built as an advertisement!

**Sweet Invention** Did you know that the delicious 'Hot Fudge Sundae' ice cream treat was actually invented in Los Angeles?

### STADIUM FACTS

**Most Expensive** SoFi Stadium cost \$5.5 billion to build, making it the most expensive and high-tech sports stadium ever made!

**Indoor-Outdoor** The stadium has a giant clear roof, but the sides are open to let the cool ocean breezes flow through the seats!

**The Infinity Screen** Hanging from the roof is a double-sided 4K video board that is shaped like a giant oval and is larger than the field!

**Earthquake Proof** To stay safe, the stadium's massive roof is held up by 37 giant pillars that are designed to withstand earthquakes!

### WOW MOMENTS

**Star Power LA** is home to more movie stars and celebrities than any other city, and you might even spot one at a soccer game!

**Massive Size** The stadium is so big that it covers 3 million square feet, which is enough space to fit many city blocks inside!

**Star Gazing** The city is home to the Griffith Observatory, where you can look through giant telescopes at the stars in space!

**Entertainment Park** The stadium is the center of 'Hollywood Park,' a 298-acre area filled with shops, parks, and a giant lake!



## Player Profile

### Cristiano Ronaldo | Portugal

Forward | Al Nassr

#### CAREER

**CR7 Legend** Cristiano Ronaldo is one of the greatest soccer players in history and is famous for his 'CR7' brand!

**Goal King** Ronaldo has scored over 900 goals in his career, more than almost any other player who has ever lived!

**International Star** He holds the world record for scoring the most goals for a national team, with over 120 goals for Portugal!

**Global Journey** In his amazing career, he has played for giant teams like Manchester United, Real Madrid, Juventus, and Al Nassr!

#### ACHIEVEMENTS

**5x Ballon d'Or** Cristiano has been named the best player in the entire world five different times!

**Champions League** He has won the UEFA Champions League trophy 5 times, which is a record for the modern version of the tournament!

**Euro Champion** In 2016, he led his home country of Portugal to victory in the European Championship for the first time!

**Trophy Collector** Throughout his career, he has won over 30 major trophies, including league titles in England, Spain, and Italy!

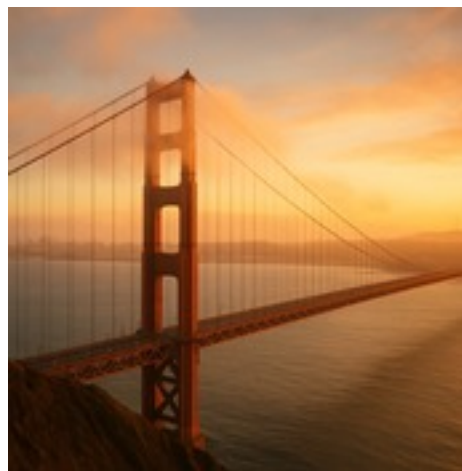
#### EXTRA

**Madeira Born** Ronaldo was born on the small island of Madeira in Portugal, and they even named the island's airport after him!

**Super Athlete** He is famous for his incredibly strict diet and for working out in the gym for many hours every single day!

**No Tattoos** Unlike many players, Ronaldo has no tattoos because he regularly donates blood and wants to keep his blood healthy!

**Jump Power** Ronaldo can jump higher than a professional basketball player, allowing him to score amazing headers from way up in the air!



## #9 Levi's Stadium \* The Silicon Giant

Santa Clara, CA (Bay Area)

### CITY SPOTLIGHT

**Golden Gate** The San Francisco Bay Area is home to the world-famous Golden Gate Bridge, which is painted a color called 'International Orange!'

**Silicon Valley** This area is the high-tech center of the world, where famous companies like Google, Apple, and Facebook were started!

**Cable Cars** San Francisco is the only city in the world with moving cable cars that people can ride up and down the steep hills!

**Fortune Cookies** Even though people think they are from China, the modern fortune cookie was actually invented in San Francisco!

### STADIUM FACTS

**Smart Stadium** At Levi's Stadium, fans can order food and watch replays right from their phone using a special stadium app!

**Rooftop Farm** The stadium has a 'Faithful Farm' on its roof where they grow real tomatoes, peppers, and herbs for the food served inside!

**Solar Power** The parking lots are covered with 20,000 solar panels that help create enough clean energy to power the entire stadium!

**Net-Zero Energy** On game days, the stadium creates as much energy as it uses, which is amazing for such a big building!

### WOW MOMENTS

**Karl the Fog** San Francisco has a famous fog named 'Karl' that often rolls over the hills and has its own social media page!

**Alcatraz Island** In the middle of the bay sits the famous Alcatraz prison, which was once home to some of the world's most dangerous criminals!

**Sourdough Secret** San Francisco is famous for its sourdough bread, which has a unique taste because of the special bacteria only found there!

**Teddy Bears** The famous 'Teddy Bear' stuffed animal was actually named after President Teddy Roosevelt, who has a strong connection to the area!



## Player Profile

### Bernardo Silva | Portugal

Midfielder | Manchester City

#### CAREER

**The Architect** Bernardo Silva is called the 'Architect' because he plans and builds attacks like a brilliant engineer!

**Midfield Maestro** Bernardo plays as a midfielder, which means he controls the game and makes clever passes to his teammates!

**Portugal Pride** He has played over 90 times for Portugal and has been a key player in their most successful teams!

**Man City Star** Bernardo plays for Manchester City in England, one of the best teams in the world!

#### ACHIEVEMENTS

**4x Premier League** Bernardo has won the Premier League title four times with Manchester City, dominating English soccer!

**Champions League** In 2023, he helped Manchester City win the UEFA Champions League for the first time in their history!

**Nations League** He helped Portugal win the Nations League in 2019, which is a major international tournament!

**Hat-Trick Hero** Bernardo scored a 'perfect hat-trick' (one goal with each foot and one with his head) in a Champions League game!

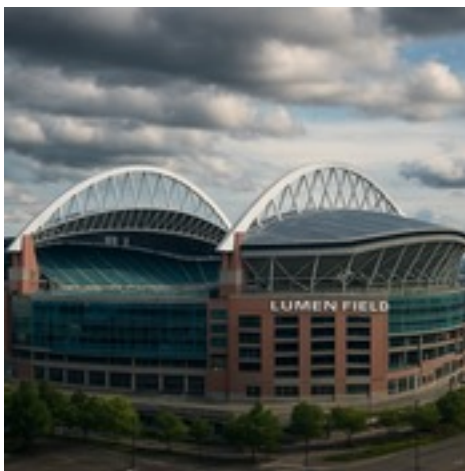
#### EXTRA

**Lisbon Born** Bernardo was born in Lisbon, the beautiful capital city of Portugal, and grew up playing soccer in the streets!

**Music Lover** When he's not playing soccer, Bernardo loves to play the guitar and listen to music from all around the world!

**Dog Dad** He has an adorable pet dog named 'Bolota' who has become famous on his social media pages!

**Clever Player** Bernardo is known for his incredible soccer IQ, always being one step ahead of his opponents on the field!



## #10 Lumen Field \* The Roaring Giant

Seattle, WA

### CITY SPOTLIGHT

**Emerald City** Seattle is called the 'Emerald City' because of the evergreen trees and beautiful green forests that surround it!

**Coffee Capital** The world-famous Starbucks coffee company opened its very first store in Seattle's historic Pike Place Market!

**Flying Fish** At Pike Place Market, fish vendors throw giant fish through the air to each other, delighting visitors every day!

**City of Hills** Seattle is built on seven different hills, similar to the famous city of Rome in Italy!

### STADIUM FACTS

**Loudest Stadium** Lumen Field is known as the loudest stadium in the world, and has actually caused earthquakes from cheering!

**Sound Focus** The stadium is shaped like a horseshoe, which focuses the crowd's roar onto the field, making it super intense!

**Seahawks Home** The stadium is home to the Seattle Seahawks, whose '12th Man' fans are legendary for their noise and passion!

**Soccer Ready** The grass field at Lumen Field is specially designed to handle the quick turns and action of FIFA soccer!

### WOW MOMENTS

**Space Needle** Seattle's most famous landmark is the Space Needle, a 605-foot tall tower built for the 1962 World's Fair!

**Grunge Music** Seattle is the birthplace of 'grunge' music, which was made famous by bands like Nirvana and Pearl Jam!

**Rain Reputation** Seattle is famous for its rain, but it actually gets less yearly rainfall than many other US cities like New York!

**Ferry Capital** Seattle has the largest ferry system in the United States, carrying millions of cars and people across the water!



## Player Profile

### Virgil van Dijk | Netherlands

Defender | Liverpool

#### CAREER

**Defensive Wall** Virgil van Dijk is one of the best defenders in the world, known for being almost impossible to get past!

**Dutch Captain** Virgil is the captain of the Netherlands national team and leads from the back with his strength and calmness!

**Never Beaten** For an incredible 50 games in a row, nobody was able to dribble past Virgil a record for a defender!

**Towering Height** Standing at 6'4" (193 cm), Virgil uses his height to win almost every header and block crosses!

#### ACHIEVEMENTS

**UEFA Player of the Year** In 2019, Virgil was named the best player in Europe, the first defender to win this award!

**Champions League** He led Liverpool to victory in the 2019 Champions League final with his dominant defensive performance!

**Ballon d'Or 2nd** He finished second in the 2019 Ballon d'Or, the highest ever ranking for a defender!

**Premier League King** One year later, he helped Liverpool win the English Premier League for the first time in 30 years!

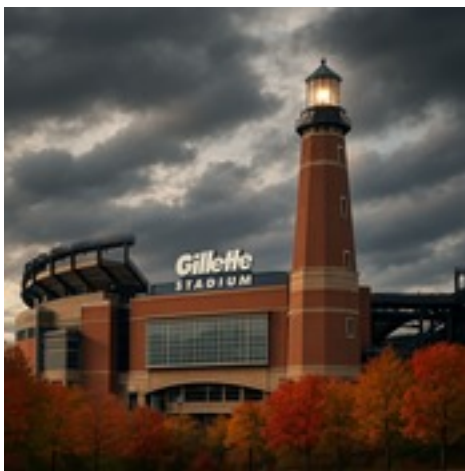
#### EXTRA

**Breda Born** Virgil was born in Breda, Netherlands, and started his career cleaning the boots of senior players!

**Breakfast Chef** He is famous for cooking special breakfasts for his teammates, making his own fresh omelettes!

**Reading Habit** Virgil loves to read books about leadership and mental strength to help him become a better captain!

**Calm Composure** One of Virgil's secrets is staying calm even in the most chaotic moments of a big match!



## #11 Gillette Stadium \* The Lighthouse Giant

Foxborough, MA (Boston)

### CITY SPOTLIGHT

**Historic Boston** Boston is one of the oldest cities in America and is where the American Revolution began!

**Freedom Trail** You can follow the Freedom Trail, a 2.5 mile walk that takes you past 16 of the most important historic sites in America!

**Lobster Love** Boston is world-famous for its delicious lobster rolls and creamy clam chowder soup!

**First School** Boston opened the first public school in America way back in 1635, which is still open and teaching kids today!

### STADIUM FACTS

**Lighthouse Icon** Gillette Stadium has a real, working 22-story tall lighthouse that lights up the sky and can be seen from far away!

**Super Bowl Central** This stadium has hosted an incredible six Super Bowls, including the epic 2022 championship game!

**New England Charm** The stadium has a beautiful bridge modeled after the historic Longfellow Bridge in Boston!

**Revolution Home** Besides American football, the stadium is also the home of the New England Revolution soccer team!

### WOW MOMENTS

**Harvard University** Just a short drive away, you can visit Harvard, the oldest university in America, founded way back in 1636!

**Fenway Park** Boston is home to Fenway Park, the oldest baseball stadium in America, which opened in 1912!

**Tea Party History** In 1773, angry colonists dumped 342 chests of tea into Boston Harbor to protest unfair taxes!

**Cheers** Boston is the city that inspired the famous 'Cheers' TV show, and you can still visit the bar where it was filmed!



## Player Profile

### Gianluigi Donnarumma | Italy

Goalkeeper | PSG

#### CAREER

**Giant in Goal** Gianluigi Donnarumma is a massive 6'5" goalkeeper from Italy who fills up the entire goal with his reach!

**Paris Star Gigio** (his nickname) plays for Paris Saint-Germain in France, one of the most famous clubs in the world!

**Italian Legend** He has already played over 60 times for Italy and is on track to become their most-capped goalkeeper ever!

**Goals? Not Him!** As a goalkeeper, Gigio's job is to stop goals, not score them, so his goal count stays at zero!

#### ACHIEVEMENTS

**Euro Hero** Gianluigi was named the Player of the Tournament when Italy won the 2020 European Championship!

**Penalty Stopper** In the Euro 2020 final, he saved two penalties in the shootout to help Italy win the trophy!

**Youngest Ever** When he started playing for AC Milan, he was the youngest goalkeeper to ever debut in the Italian league!

**Ligue 1 Winner** He has won multiple league titles in France and was named the league's best goalkeeper!

#### EXTRA

**Castellammare Born** Gigio was born in Castellammare di Stabia, a beautiful coastal town near Naples, Italy!

**Teenage Debut** He made his professional debut for AC Milan when he was just 16 years old, shocking everyone with his skill!

**Wall Reflexes** Donnarumma is famous for his lightning-fast reflexes, making impossible saves that seem to defy gravity!

**Brother Goalie** Gigio's older brother Antonio is also a professional goalkeeper, so soccer runs in the family!

# WORLD CUP

BY THE NUMBERS & TECH CORNER

48 104 3

TEAMS

MATCHES

HOST  
COUNTRIES



GOAL-LINE  
TECHNOLOGY

# World Cup 2026 \* By The Numbers

**48 Nations**

Most teams ever

**104 Matches**

Record-breaking games

**16 Host Cities**

USA, Mexico, Canada

**11 Stadium Giants**

Unique personalities

**3 Countries**

First tri-host World Cup

**5 Billion**

Estimated TV viewers

**40,000 Tons**

Steel in MetLife

**11,000+ Solar Panels**

Power at The Linc

**160 ft Video Board**

AT&T's giant screen

**8 Min Roof Open**

Mercedes-Benz halo

**70,000+ Avg Capacity**

Across all 11

**\$5.5B Stadium**

SoFi cost

**5.8 Million**

Total tickets available

**1 Million+**

Fans visiting from abroad

**60,000+**

Helpful volunteers on site

**40+ Languages**

Broadcast to the world

**\$440 Million**

2022 total prize pool

**10,000+**

Media and news reporters

**\$14 Billion**

Boost to host economy

**1,200+ Players**

Star athletes in action

**32 Days**

Non-stop soccer action

**48 NATIONS · 1 TROPHY · 32 DAYS**

A wide-angle photograph of a football stadium at night, filled with a large crowd of spectators. In the foreground, many fans are waving Mexican flags (green, white, and red). The pitch is brightly lit by stadium lights, and several players are visible on the field. In the background, fireworks are exploding in the dark sky above the stadium. The text "KEEP DREAMING. KEEP PLAYING. KEEP ROARING!" is overlaid in large, white, serif capital letters across the upper half of the image.

KEEP DREAMING.  
KEEP PLAYING.  
KEEP ROARING!